

Copperleaf Kitchens

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

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Approved By: Corporate HR Director

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Revision History

Version	Date	Description	Author
1.0	Mar 2023	Initial release	HR Dept
2.0	Jan 2024	Updated leave policies, added food safety section	HR Dept
3.0	Jan 2025	Revised disciplinary process, added recognition program, clarified confidentiality	HR Director

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1. Company Overview

Copperleaf Kitchens is a premier restaurant group operating across Egypt with branches in Alexandria, Cairo, Giza, and Mansoura. We specialize in contemporary Egyptian and Mediterranean cuisine, serving over 2,000 guests daily. Our company was founded in 2015 and has grown to 450 employees across all branches. Corporate headquarters is located in Cairo and houses Human Resources, Kitchen Operations, Procurement, Food Safety, Finance, and Compliance departments. Each branch operates under a local management team and follows standardized procedures set by the corporate office.

Scenario: A new employee at the Mansoura Branch asks about the company's history. They are directed to the onboarding portal which contains the full company profile and branch facts.

2. Mission, Vision and Core Values

Mission: To serve memorable meals with outstanding hospitality in a clean, safe, and sustainable environment. **Vision:** To become Egypt's most beloved restaurant brand, recognized for quality and community care. **Core Values:** Integrity, Teamwork, Excellence, Respect, and Accountability. These values guide every decision, from hiring to guest interaction. Employees are expected to demonstrate these values daily.

Scenario: A server at the Giza Branch notices a colleague giving incorrect change to a customer. The server politely corrects the mistake and informs the shift leader, demonstrating Integrity and Teamwork.

Value	Definition
Integrity	Doing the right thing even when no one is watching
Teamwork	Supporting colleagues and sharing success
Excellence	Delivering high quality consistently
Respect	Treating all with dignity
Accountability	Owning actions and outcomes

3. Organizational Structure

Each branch is led by a Branch Manager who reports to the Regional Operations Department. Corporate departments support all branches: Human Resources, Kitchen Operations, Procurement, Food Safety, Finance, and Compliance. Kitchen staff report to the Head Chef, who reports to the Branch Manager. Front-of-house staff report to the Service Manager. The Corporate Chef oversees menus and quality standards across branches.

Workflow (Reporting Line): Employee → Shift Supervisor → Branch Manager → Regional Operations → CEO.

4. Employee Code of Conduct (EH-101)

All employees must act honestly, follow lawful instructions, avoid conflicts of interest, maintain a respectful workplace, and comply with all policies. Prohibited behaviors include theft, fraud, discrimination, harassment, substance abuse, and unauthorized disclosure of proprietary information. Violations lead to disciplinary action up to termination. See Corporate Compliance Policy (CP-502) for details on ethics reporting.

Do	Don't
Arrive on time and ready to work	Use company resources for personal gain
Wear uniform properly	Accept bribes or kickbacks
Follow lawful instructions	Create a hostile work environment

Scenario: An employee at the Cairo Branch is offered a free meal by a supplier in exchange for ordering more products. The employee reports this to the Branch Manager and refuses the gift, following the conflict of interest rule.

5. Equal Employment Policy (EH-115)

We provide equal opportunity regardless of race, color, religion, gender, age, disability, or marital status. All hiring, promotions, and terminations are merit-based. Reasonable accommodation is provided for employees with disabilities. Complaints of discrimination are investigated thoroughly. Refer to EH-115 and Corporate Compliance Policy (CP-502) for the full procedure.

Scenario: A disabled applicant at the Alexandria Branch requests a wheelchair-accessible workstation. HR arranges the accommodation without delay.

6. Anti-Harassment Policy

We have zero tolerance for harassment or discrimination based on any protected characteristic. Harassment includes verbal, physical, visual, or online conduct. Any employee who experiences or witnesses harassment must report it to their manager, HR, or the anonymous hotline. Investigations are confidential and non-retaliatory. Failing to report allows misconduct to continue.

Checklist for Reporting Harassment:

- 1. Document the incident (date, time, details).
- 2. Report to manager or HR.
- 3. HR opens a case.
- 4. Investigator interviews parties.
- 5. Corrective action taken.

Scenario: A waiter at the Giza Branch is repeatedly mocked by a coworker because of his accent. He reports this to the Service Manager, who escalates to HR. HR conducts a formal investigation and the offending employee receives a final written warning.

7. Attendance and Punctuality (EH-204)

Punctuality is essential for smooth operations. Employees must clock in/out using the biometric system. Lateness is categorized as follows: 1-10 minutes = minor, 11-30 minutes = moderate, over 30 minutes = major. Accumulating 3 major or 5 minor lateness in a month leads to a written warning. See EH-204 for thresholds. All employees must notify their manager immediately if they will be late.

Lateness (minutes)	Category	Action
1-10	Minor	Verbal reminder
11-30	Moderate	Documented in file
31+	Major	Written warning

Workflow (Late Arrival): Clock in → Supervisor notified → HR logs lateness → Points accumulate → Disciplinary review at threshold.

Scenario: An employee arrives 30 minutes late for the opening shift at Alexandria Branch. They immediately call the manager, submit a written explanation, and the lateness is recorded as moderate. A performance coaching session follows.

8. Shift Scheduling

Shifts are posted seven days in advance in the employee portal and on the branch notice board. Standard shifts: Morning 7AM-3PM, Evening 3PM-11PM. Employees must check the schedule daily. Request changes via the shift swap form and obtain manager approval. Unauthorized swaps are considered absences. Scheduling conflicts should be raised at least 48 hours before the scheduled shift.

Checklist for Shift Swap:

1. Find a willing colleague.
2. Both sign the swap form.
3. Submit to manager for approval.
4. Manager confirms in writing.

Scenario: A chef at the Cairo Branch needs to swap an evening shift with a colleague. They complete the form and get the Branch Manager's signed approval before the swap is effective.

9. Overtime Rules

Overtime is only allowed with prior manager approval. Emergency overtime may be approved retroactively when justified. Overtime is compensated at 1.5x hourly rate or compensatory time off as per Egyptian labour law. Employees cannot work more than 12 hours per day including overtime. Unauthorized overtime may be subject to discipline. See HR policy EH-302 for leave and overtime interactions.

Scenario: A kitchen team at the Mansoura Branch must prepare for a large banquet. The Head Chef requests 4 hours overtime from each cook, obtains Branch Manager approval, and HR records the extra hours.

10. Leave Policy (EH-302)

All leaves must be requested using the HR portal. Annual leave: 21 days per year. Sick leave: paid per medical certificate after 1 day. Emergency leave: up to 3 days with approval. Maternity leave: 90 days paid. Paternity leave: 3 days. Unpaid leave may be granted at manager discretion. All requests require approval by the Branch Manager and HR. See EH-302 for full conditions.

Leave Type	Duration	Approval Required
Annual	21 days	2 weeks notice
Sick	As per doctor	Medical certificate
Emergency	Up to 3 days	Immediate notice

Workflow (Leave Request): Submit in portal → Manager reviews → HR verifies balance → Approved/rejected → scheduled.

Scenario: A server at the Giza Branch requests 5 days of annual leave 2 weeks in advance. The manager approves after confirming coverage.

11. Dress Code

All staff must wear the standard uniform: black trousers, white shirt, apron, and non-slip shoes. Kitchen staff must wear chef coats and hairnets. Safety shoes are mandatory. Uniforms must be clean, pressed, and in good repair. Name badges are worn at all times. Denim, visible tattoos, or strong perfumes are not allowed. A full dress code chart is available in the HR portal.

Scenario: A new hostess at the Cairo Branch arrives without the proper apron. The manager gives her a temporary one and counsels her on uniform standards.

12. Personal Hygiene Standards

Handwashing is required before starting work, after breaks, after handling raw food, and after using the restroom. Fingernails must be short and clean; lower-priced simple studs allowed. Hair must be tied back and covered if in kitchen. Daily shower and clean uniform are mandatory. Open cuts must be covered with a waterproof bandage. See Food Safety Manual (FS-302) for full hygiene protocols.

Scenario: A cook at the Alexandria Branch reports a cut on his hand. The supervisor provides a waterproof dressing and reassigns him to non-food handling tasks until healed.

13. Customer Service Standards

Greet every guest within 30 seconds of arrival. Make eye contact and smile. Handle complaints politely and escalate if needed. Service recovery: for any complaint, offer a free dessert or drink. Ask open questions to ensure satisfaction. Thank guests when they leave. Follow the 10/5 rule: at 10 feet smile, at 5 feet greet.

Workflow (Complaint Handling): Listen → Apologize → Find solution → Offer recovery → Follow up.

Scenario: A guest at the Cairo Branch complains that the soup is cold. The server apologizes, replaces it immediately, and offers a free dessert. The guest leaves happy.

14. Workplace Safety

Follow all safety guidelines, report hazards immediately, and participate in safety drills. Use equipment only after training. Stack heavy items safely. Clean spills immediately. Wear appropriate protective equipment. Regularly inspect work areas. See Branch Operations Manual (BO-410) for daily safety inspections. Employees must know the location of fire extinguishers and first aid kits.

Checklist (Daily Safety):

1. Check wet floors and notify.
2. Check knife storage.
3. Check electrical cords.
4. Verify fire exits accessible.

Scenario: An employee at the Mansoura Branch sees a broken tile in the dining area. He reports it to the manager and places a warning sign, preventing injury.

15. Emergency Procedures

In case of fire: EVACUATE, call 180, assemble at the designated point. In a medical emergency, call 112 and alert the manager. For bomb threats or suspicious packages, notify security and evacuate calmly. Roles and maps are posted in each branch. Drills are held quarterly. Employees must know two exits from their workstation.

Workflow (Fire Emergency): Alert → Evacuate → Call 180 → Assemble → Headcount → Report.

Scenario: A minor kitchen fire breaks out in the Giza Branch. Staff use the fire extinguisher, call 180, and evacuate. The Branch Manager confirms everyone is safe.

16. Accident Reporting

All accidents, even minor ones, must be reported to a supervisor immediately. Search for the blue incident report form or file online. If medical attention is needed, go to the nearest clinic. Complete the Incident Report (IR-001) within 24 hours. Attach witness statements and photos. Keep a copy for your records. Failure to report may result in disciplinary action.

Scenario: A server slips on an oily floor and twists his ankle. He reports to the manager, visits the clinic, and completes IR-001 the same day.

17. Incident Reporting Procedure

For any near-miss, property damage, or safety hazard, document details in the Incident Report system. Include the location, people involved, and actions taken. Notify the manager and security. Use the three-step process: (1) Secure the scene, (2) Gather facts, (3) Submit the report. Incident reports help prevent future accidents. Refer to Corporate Compliance Policy (CP-502) for escalation of serious incidents.

Scenario: A package is delivered and boxes are left blocking a fire exit. An employee moves the boxes and files an incident report about the near-miss.

18. Confidentiality Policy (EH-410)

Do not disclose company information, recipes, customer data, or financial details to outsiders. This includes social media posts and conversations with friends. Confidential information includes pricing, supplier agreements, and personnel records. Breach leads to disciplinary action, including termination and legal action. Even after leaving the company, confidentiality obligations continue. See EH-410 and Corporate Compliance Policy (CP-502) for exceptions.

Scenario: A former employee posts secret recipes on social media. The company sends a cease-and-desist and pursues legal action.

19. Acceptable Use of Company Systems

Use company computers and networks for work only. Passwords must be strong and changed every 90 days. Do not install unauthorized software. Do not access inappropriate websites. Company email is for business communication. Report any suspicious activity to IT. Personal devices may be used but not for work-related sensitive data.

Scenario: An employee clicks a phishing link and enters his password. He immediately changes it and reports to IT, preventing further damage.

20. Food Safety Responsibilities

All staff must adhere to HACCP standards. Keep hot food above 60°C and cold food below 5°C. Label and date all items. Report any signs of contamination, pest activity, or equipment failure. Use separate cutting boards for raw meats and vegetables. Wash hands when switching tasks. See Food Safety Manual (FS-302) and Waste Management Policy (WM-204) for disposal and storage requirements.

Food Type	Temperature	Check Frequency
Cold storage	0-5°C	Every 4 hours
Hot holding	60°C+	Every 2 hours
Freezer	-18°C	Daily

Scenario: A sous chef at the Alexandria Branch notices the walk-in cooler temperature is 8°C. He moves food to backup cold storage and reports the equipment issue to maintenance and food safety office.

21. Branch Manager Responsibilities

Branch Managers ensure operational excellence, staff supervision, and compliance. They are responsible for daily opening/closing procedures, inventory monitoring, staff scheduling, and customer satisfaction. They must conduct weekly safety checks and hold team meetings. They report to Regional Operations. Managers approve leave requests, shift changes, and minor expenses. Full role description is in Branch Operations Manual (BO-410).

Scenario: The Branch Manager at the Mansoura Branch notices a decline in hygiene scores. He organizes retraining and increases spot checks to resolve the issue.

22. Performance Evaluation

Formal evaluations are conducted every 6 months. Managers provide feedback on attendance, quality of work, customer service, teamwork, and adherence to policies. Scores range from 1 to 5. A score below 3 triggers a performance improvement plan. High performers are eligible for bonuses and promotions. Employees may submit self-assessments before the review.

Rating	Meaning	Action
5	Outstanding	Promotion/raise
4	Exceeds	Bonus
3	Meets	Standard
2	Below	Improvement plan
1	Unsatisfactory	Disciplinary

Scenario: After a strong customer service evaluation, a server at the Giza Branch gets a 4 rating and a recognition award.

23. Training Requirements

All employees must complete onboarding orientation (2 days), food safety certification (4 hours), and service training (3 days). Refresher courses are required annually. Advanced training is available for kitchen ladder and management development. Training is recorded in the HR system. Promotion requires completing relevant training modules.

Scenario: A chef at the Cairo Branch is promoted to sous chef after completing the Kitchen Leadership Program and passing the internal exam.

24. Disciplinary Process

Disciplinary actions follow a progressive system: verbal warning, written warning, final warning, and termination. The process is documented and consistent. Immediate termination may occur for serious misconduct such as theft, violence, or food safety violations. Employees have the right to appeal in writing within 5 days. See Corporate Compliance Policy (CP-502) for appeal procedures.

Workflow (Discipline): Verbal warning → Written warning → Final warning → Termination → Appeal → HR review.

Scenario: An employee repeatedly forgets to wear his hairnet. He receives two verbal warnings, then a written warning. After a third offense, he receives a final warning.

25. Employee Recognition Program

Exceptional service is rewarded monthly. Winners receive a certificate and a gift card. Nominations come from peers and managers. Annual awards honor top performers in categories: Customer Service, Teamwork, Safety, and Food Quality. Winners are announced at the all-staff meeting.

Scenario: The team at the Alexandria Branch nominates a dishwasher for his outstanding dedication during a busy weekend. He wins the monthly award.

26. Employee Exit Procedure

Exit interviews are scheduled upon resignation. Return all company property: uniform, keys, ID, and equipment. Final paycheck is issued within 7 days. Clearance must be signed by department heads. Non-compete and confidentiality agreements are reviewed. See HR for the exit checklist.

Checklist (Exit):

1. Notify manager in writing.
2. Complete clearance form.
3. Return items.
4. Attend exit interview.
5. Receive final pay.

Scenario: A hostess at the Cairo Branch resigns with two weeks' notice. She completes her clearance and leaves on good terms.

27. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How do I request time off? A: Use the HR portal and submit at least 2 weeks in advance for vacation. Q: What if I need a shift swap? A: Obtain manager approval and sign the swap form. Q: What if I am sick? A: Call your manager before shift and provide a medical certificate. Q: What is the policy on confidentiality? A: See EH-410; never share company information externally.

28. Appendix

Contains forms: IR-001 Incident Report, Leave Request Form, Shift Swap Form, Exit Clearance Form. Refer also to Food Safety Manual (FS-302), Waste Management Policy (WM-204), Supplier & Procurement Policy (SP-205), Branch Operations Manual (BO-410), and Corporate Compliance Policy (CP-502).

Approval Signatures

Role: Human Resources Director	Signature: _____
Role: Regional Operations Manager	Signature: _____
Role: CEO	Signature: _____